Who should I vote for? End to end

From a voice note to a recommendation: what I think, what I care about, the analysis, and the result. 27 October 2026 Knesset election

Daniel Rosehill · prepared with Claude (Anthropic, claude-opus-5-5) · 27 October 2026
github.com/danielrosehill/Israel-Election-2026-Vote-Decision

How this was made

This document runs the whole project end to end, on election day, 27 October 2026.

1. **Voice note (26 October 2026, 42 min).** I recorded what I think is broken in Israeli politics and what I care about, and set the research task: build an objective rubric from my priorities, score every list on the ballot, rank them, and recommend.
2. **Transcription.** AssemblyAI (universal model), raw transcript kept unedited. Two cleaned versions: disfluencies removed, and lightly edited (false starts and repetition removed, sectioned, mishearings corrected and listed).
3. **Audio.** The committed audio is tidied using the word timestamps: 313 filler and stutter words and every pause over 0.7 s cut (42:28 → 35:15). Nothing else is changed. Every cut is logged in `audio-cuts.json`.
4. **Rubric.** Derived from the note, with each position cited to its timestamp. Stream A covers the everyday pain points; Stream B covers the divisive national issues.
5. **Research.** Four agents gathered sourced evidence on every list (38 filed; Blue and White withdrew on 19 October), from party platforms, party sites, the Israel Democracy Institute and the press. Lists come from my Hugging Face dataset of the CEC candidate lists.
6. **Scoring and ranking.** One agent scored all lists on all 15 criteria from that evidence. `scripts/rank.py` computes Stream A, Stream B and combined scores, checks them against the polls, and produces the recommendation.

Repo: github.com/danielrosehill/Israel-Election-2026-Vote-Decision

What I’m thinking: the voice note

The voice note, recorded 26 October 2026, lightly edited (false starts and repetition removed). Raw transcript in the appendix.

Politics voice note: edited transcript

Light edit of Daniel’s voice note: his words in the first person, every point kept, with false starts, repetition and abandoned clauses removed and grammar fixed only where needed for readability. Section headings are added; the time in brackets is where each section starts in the audio.

Recorded: 2026-10-26 (the day before the 27 October 2026 Knesset election)

Sources: raw transcript · disfluencies removed

Why this note exists (00:00)

Okay, so today is 26th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. Like many people in Israel, I feel very disillusioned and disenfranchised with the entire political system. So I’m turning to you, Claude, to create a guide tailored to my own vote: what I’m looking for in a party, as it were. I’ll set it out in this voice note, which will be in a public repository. That’s intentional, in case you’re asking.

We’ll do our usual process: send this audio file for transcription, then get a cleaned-up version. Please keep the audio file, the binary, in the repo and link to it in the README, in case anyone wants to hear the original for chain of custody. Not that I can think of any reason why.

It’s a demonstration, I guess, of a voice-to-research workflow that I use a lot. I use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in, and then I send Claude off to do his Claude-like thing. Usually I pair that with some kind of output skill, which typically uses Typst (I keep thinking I’m pronouncing it wrong), the typesetting program, which is just a fantastic tool. So I’ll usually round out the skill by saying: Claude, summarise your research, bake it into a PDF, put it in my Google Drive, send it to me by email. That’s the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes it’s a one-off, sometimes it’s recurring. This one is just a public demo.

Sometimes I’ll generate a podcast from it, and I might create a podcast episode from this one too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds. Or both; they’re complementary.

Okay, so here are basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

The Knesset and the electoral system: no accountability (02:14)

I’m recording this looking at the Israeli parliament building from a window here. Not metaphorically: literally. I can see it from where I’m recording, and when I look at it I feel disgust rising at an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens. This house is a farce. It’s not representing the interests of the Israeli electorate. It’s a collection of self-important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in ancient Israel and some of its manifestations, the 120 seats. It’s a slight on the old institution. It’s a [unclear: “sugbet”] Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

My long-standing critique of Israeli politics is that the whole litany of things I feel is broken and wrong with it stems from one rotten root: in the way this country is set up, in our electoral system here, there is no accountability baked into the system. And we have an electorate that accepts this, because this is the way things are here. This is my external critique, as someone who moved here from Ireland: Israelis are at once very worldly and, in a peculiar way (I’m having a hard time with some words today), insular, in the sense that this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

My frame of reference is having grown up in Ireland. Its political system has its own pros and cons, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that you vote for a politician for an electoral area at the national elections, so there is, theoretically, someone you can complain to or contact to get representation. Here we have a completely broken political system. Its design has incentivised an extremely fractured and divisive politics, characterised by repeated breakaway alliances that split votes. Those are less often created to offer genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms, and more often because some

person didn't get the slate they thought was becoming to them, so they decided to form a breakaway party. Or the party exists because one of its core principles is "we will not be in government with this party". What they all have in common is that none of them articulates anything about what the party is going to do for the electorate, for the people. That's the fundamental problem with Israeli politics as I see it.

So naturally I've been reading about who's running in this election, and trying even to summon up the motivation to do that, because it's exhausting. There are three, four, five more political parties than last time. Why? Who? The first question you'd ask about any of them is: what do they stand for that's actually going to benefit my life? And nothing you read in the news has anything to do with that. Because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided, the way parties in this system differentiate themselves is by the slice of the electorate they pander to, instead of by collective issues.

And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation is this. I could say, okay, hopefully Netanyahu won't be elected. He's the one person I'm definitely not voting for. But when people say, well, what about Eisenkot, what about this party or that party, I say it's the same problem. That's where I'm even more pessimistic than some people here, because I say: yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see there are parties saying "we demand that the Haredi draft exemption end", or about the judicial reform?

Meanwhile, of the issues that matter to me in my ten years living in the State of Israel as an immigrant from Ireland, the most detrimental thing, the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is one that, last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

Tenant protection and the move (08:21)

I spent most of June and July (it's all a blur this summer) basically moving apartment ourselves. We did that because of our previous landlord. We had a leak: I woke up one day to find water dripping on my bed. We told the landlord on the day. After two weeks I asked him, "So are you going to fix it?" He came the next day and then sent us a very pleasant message: of course I'm going to get it fixed, I'm going to get right on it. And the next day he followed up with an extremely angry [unclear: "I couldn't believe state the apart"] and basically retaliatory termination of the lease.

Our son is now 15 months old; at the time he was much younger. We were sleeping as a family on the couch, because it got to the point where there was mould growing on the roof of our room. I was sending the landlord video updates saying: for your sake, not mine, you probably want to get on this ASAP, because your place is being ruined. I literally did everything in my power to make it happen. The law says they have three days to do it. And of course he just didn't, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

What's the point of having a law if the lesson, the chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends, my colleagues and the rest, is: don't dare exercise even the minimal rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease? Because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. Even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease termination, it made absolutely no difference.

This is the issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix it. We even tried to explain to the landlord that we need somewhere to live, and he's like, yeah, okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but you do realise that we need a roof over our heads? I don't know if that point was lost in translation there, Mr Landlord.

When we went to our lawyer, we got kind of the same reaction. So my wife and I were both like: okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. You go to viewing after viewing after viewing. First you have to pay an illegal agency fee, because every single agent has cornered the market in what is basically a scam, one that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law. It's illegal, they found this ridiculous workaround for it, and de facto you have to pay it: one month's rent plus VAT as the agent fee. So if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekends spent trudging around with a young baby (neither of us has family in Israel), in the heat of the summer, to see depressing places. The pinnacle of it: a new trend started where you'd see on listings "image was enhanced with artificial intelligence". So you're like, wait, this is an AI image of the place you're posting?

And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name, because the Jerusalem municipality, in all its infinite wisdom, with which it exerts itself digging up the city and making this place chaos, has not come up with any workable system for tenants to pay their Arnona, the highest in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you literally have to do unpaid admin work for the landlord, and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill, plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it. Then in the next place you've the pleasure of doing all of it again.

The last time we moved before that, similar story. That landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place, after paying rent on time every single month, because he wanted to give his apartment to his daughters.

I can't even describe the cumulative, mental sense of loss of stability: a profound sense of not feeling like you have a place. We're working, we're saving. My wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we look at the spreadsheets and say: A, it doesn't really matter, because the numbers just don't seem to check out for us to do this. And B, even if they did, even if we did everything in our power to get on the property ladder and lived off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it, because of what each move costs. The last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekels, plus time off work.

This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and hears a man ranting for ten minutes about how he spent his summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes, doing as much of the move as I could because, between all these expenses, deposits and agent fees, we literally had to have a cheap move to ensure cash flow: that's when I look around and ask, how is the state…? For me, this is the biggest setback to the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel, having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but the cost of living and the rest of it are such that getting on the property ladder is near impossible.

If my hourly rate were multiplied by the hours I spent tearing up ethernet cables in one rental to put them back down in the next, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding places for things, doing all that with a family, my bank account would be in a much better state than it is now. Put it like that.

So that's been the drain, mentally, spiritually, personally, that has sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration, anger and cynicism. Other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here. The people are great. I love the food. I've adapted to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

Jerusalem (16:12)

The bad thing is religious extremism. I find in Jerusalem that it's becoming coercive, and I don't like that. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem these days, to put it mildly; or at least, let's say, I'm less optimistic about the city than I've ever been.

That issue as well is a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment is an endless [unclear: "creation"; possibly "construction"]. It's sheer greed. It's catastrophic. The city is basically digging up left, right and centre to create this enormous glut of high-rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are investment properties or for people who won't live here, while the people actually living in the city literally watch these big, out-of-place skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to [unclear: "post a road change"]. This city is a joke. Seriously, who's actually…? You read about the cable car going to the Old City, which was the front news today on the Times of Israel, and you're like, who's calling the shots in this place? Because they do not have their heads screwed on.

This place, the poorest city in Israel, needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing and crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here. You look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor for not being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch: a city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and… yeah, no. Anyway.

Despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world, the city deserves so much better than this, and it should be a far more inclusive, affordable and accessible place. And I use all those adjectives together.

So the anger comes from my feeling that this is a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, because there's something nice about it. The good things about Jerusalem: the slower pace of life compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are maybe a bit less stylish. I like that. I really like that, actually; I'm not a very ostentatious person. But what's happening now, the stagnation of the long-term residents in the city centre and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew and don't want to interact with people: what kind of recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city, is that? It's a disaster.

So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

The Haredi draft and the social contract (19:33)

When I look at what everyone's jockeying over: do I think the Haredim, the ultra-religious, should serve in the army? Yes. I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have a state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state: the rule of law is the rule of law, and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. And I can say from our own experience: if you're a struggling young working family, being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we could talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

The Iran war and the shelters (20:28)

When the war with Iran broke out, I was kind of in disbelief. That was a long war, the one earlier this year; was it five weeks? You wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever time it started, and you're like, oh crap, what's going on? I'm kind of a prepper, or have become one, so you think, well, everything's planned, right? The shelters are open. And they're not. At the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany: there's no map, no interactive map. When the war broke out, they weren't open. I contributed a router to a shelter, and it got stolen.

And we got a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. The shelter was literally a car park: a city-run car park was a designated deep shelter. The ceasefire was announced and we were charged for, I think, an hour or two of parking, an exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering in an emergency? Are you serious?

So it's things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? How did we go from this collectivist, idealistic, poor but wholesome society to this? These dynamics are bigger than any one thing; these are just the little things I notice. But okay, to be more coherent: what affects me in my personal life, day to day?

Cost of living (22:22)

The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. Take the tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced; it's always been overpriced. It's anti-competitive. And some guy, Bezalel Smotrich, the right-wing guy, raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. Come on.

AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy, I'm convinced. Go onto any AliExpress listing and you're seeing Israeli flags, and you think, wait, is everyone buying everything from this? You ask your friends and they're like, oh yeah, we're all doing this, because everything here costs double or triple what it does abroad. And there's no warranty, or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I visit the US with my in-laws, I appreciate that they have so many internal divisions and debates there, but the biggest breath of fresh air when I visit is the feeling that there is a basic level of function. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels gratuitous. It does not need to be this way. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who gets irate (a bad example). But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business or anything else, when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff actually... oh, this is pretty nice.

Healthcare (24:05)

Other things I've noticed recently: we had to take our son to the ER twice in the last month. We had a pretty rough month. [unclear: "Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago."] I have asthma, and I have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with a cold, we come down with the cold, we're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing.

So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor, our health fund's doctor, who prescribes a Ventolin nebuliser. Okay, great. We get that, we do it, and in the middle of the night we're like, this is not working, he's getting worse. You can see him pulling his neck. We're like, okay, I don't feel good just staying here.

So we call our health fund, Maccabi. Basically, the first time, when we went to Terem, I can't remember exactly; I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care... The helpline says it's not an emergency response.

The second time, which was more recently, was much, much worse. That was terrible. We went to this urgent care place, which I won't name. Same story, exactly the same pattern. They say his oxygen is a bit low and we need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there for 20, 30 minutes. He throws up, nobody comes. There's no one working there. My wife and I are like, what do we do? Are we supposed to just wait here, like they told us? And he was refusing the oxygen; he wouldn't let us put it up to his face. So we went to the ER. They were great. And we met another family there who'd had exactly the same experience. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate is good in large areas: that's a problem.

Judicial reform, Netanyahu and the commission of inquiry (26:30)

So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. Everyone says this, but there was a time when, if I said it, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say it with conviction: I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe... whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics: you can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and with these issues, the Haredi draft, the judicial reform. Before we create ten splinter parties and debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution...

Every single time I wonder how it is that we have a political system where, electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can stand up with essentially no coherent policy platform, no research-backed platform targeting the burning issues: OECD maths scores, there's a list of them. Instead it's: we're going to create a new party that's anti-Haredim; this one's pro-Haredim; this one's a mixture. And I think it's across the board.

It's accepted by the people who vote for these parties, and there's so much fractionalism and self-interest that they can't learn the lessons of the destruction of the left, and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters... And the organisers say: the October 7th commission of inquiry, [unclear: "fault finding bring"].

Okay, that was horrific. It was a tragedy. It was horrible. Of course there should be a state commission of inquiry. But is that the most important thing? That's not a policy. "We're for a state commission of inquiry into October 7th" shouldn't be front-line policy. I see two potentially useful reasons for one. One, a security review: learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability: there have to be punishments, and if that doesn't exist, there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission: I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that it's going to eclipse everything else.

Because the Israel I see is tearing itself asunder. It's dog eat dog. Young people who move here, who make aliyah, can be kicked out of an apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in, and they're on the pavement, and the state says, that's just the way it is. I feel those are more important issues; those fixes would be more widely beneficial than the results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be.

The parties, the bread and butter, and Israel's reputation (30:25)

So I find myself looking at one party after the other, the old ones, and the jaded pattern of ex-generals creating their own party, and I just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The rotten root: the total lack of a political system that views itself as being there to represent people. Big issues, policy related to security, questions of national identity, need national consensus: a constitution and, in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those big issues are of course important, and of course they're going to delineate

between parties. But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really trite analogy.

The Israel I'd like, personally, is an Israel where hard-working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here, can vacation in Israel without it being four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And then of course the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because of whatever this rotten system of government is that requires extremist racists like Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and the others to hold it together. It's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably going to have to cut some audio at this part of the note. But I hope this explains what I care about personally.

What I want to see is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible. On the Palestinian question, I'll just say that I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any way it can be done, and I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

I think Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous, and I think honestly largely justified, international rage and disgust, and the government has done nothing about it. All we do is fund more hasbara: let's fire off some more propaganda. And the world is tired of it. And Netanyahu, after telling us that Iran was being contained, like he did last summer, suddenly retweets an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv. What kind of integrity is that? What kind of leaders...? How low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion, that this is just what passes [unclear: "what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that"], or people just laugh and say, well, that's just electioneering. But it's a dismal place to have sunk.

So I want an Israel run by thoughtful people. They don't have to be technocrats, but committed people furthering the collective good, peace and prosperity, and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalised for some reason. That's what I've noticed: the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish diaspora.

National identity and the diaspora (34:24)

My long-term philosophy here, contrarian again, is that this should not be in scope. Israel fights the view that the Jewish people and Israel are different things, and I agree there's a portion of world Jewry who aren't Zionist. But if, on the other hand, you say we're appointing ourselves the global protector, representative and guardian of world Jews, you've just created that conflation, so you can't then turn around and say... I think it's unfair, frankly.

And I don't think that, in a country with the kind of healthcare that exists here, at least in parts, we should be doing that. Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, why should we maintain this apparatus? And these other big tranches of public waste: the efforts to combat antisemitism, the efforts at public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us, which is almost glaringly... I just don't think it serves any good. I think the best answer to antisemitism and anti-Israelism is to make Israel great. You can't [unclear: "criticism"]; you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

A political class asleep at the wheel (36:05)

We see so many good things here and also so many challenges. We've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country: building it up and making it what it should be. And we've got a waste-of-time political leadership, a political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and the country are driven by the talent and skill of everyone else, including the army for that matter, and the politicians are just what they are. We need a radically reformed political system, a radical improvement in transparency, and programmes for government that are coherent.

The meta thing is a move away from those issues. There'll always be issues for parties to argue about, the security situation, if that never changes. But if that's all we view, whether we're coming from the left or the right, as legitimate for a party to articulate policy about, then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

The cottage cheese protest, the housing protest: that's ancient history in comparative terms now. Why has there been no movement since? Look at the numbers. The situation's not getting better, and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent, in proportion

to what's actually going to affect people? I think people [unclear: "be on the street for, for that didn't talk about"]: wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue.

And I think a lot of the political class's disconnect, and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent, is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old families who have a lot of property and, like many old Israeli families, have an investment stream that's being funded by newcomers. I just think it's such a perversion of the Zionist ideal. This was not the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and could have a dignified life here. I can't imagine this was anything like what Herzl intended.

So that's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election.

The research task (38:45)

What I'd like from you, Claude: I'm part writer, part-time data nerd, so I'd like to do this systematically. Take that lump of thought I've provided and give some coherence to it. I've already created a dataset for the parties on Hugging Face: the lists, who's on each list. Let's do it like this. Let's define an objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then let's review each party one by one, give it a score, and stratify the analysis by alignment.

Put security, the nation-state and Haredi enlistment to one side for the moment, and call those stream B issues. Stream A issues, what I'd call my socioeconomic and non-divisive issues, are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens. I've given just a few examples: rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy. I'd actually put Israel's global reputation in that too, because on the one hand it's a meta issue, and on the other it's one that trickles down: everyone bears it in some way or another, I believe.

First, rank the parties from best match to lowest match on stream A alone; then on both axes, so split two is alignment on both together. Then give me an analysis with a summary of the parties' positions.

What I want from a party (40:26)

As one high-level guide to what I'm looking for, my [unclear: "David Fiducia"; possibly "ideal" or "dream"] party's mission statement would be: we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th, not because we say the Haredim must serve. That language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me, because it's the next version of the same story: the last ten elections, 2026 edition. Instead: we're here because we can see that the State of Israel… we're here… (I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in [unclear: "In Tron, whatever it was. Tron"].) And this is our programme. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic. We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. This is how we think, and this is how we propose to do it. Cards on the table.

As for manifestations of that: the bar is so incredibly low that if a party had a PDF on its website for a certain area of policy, translated into all the commonly spoken languages in Israel, even that, I think, would be a hard bar to pass. But it would be a very favourable indication.

That's it. That's today's research task. And it's good that I recorded this, so it can go onto this notepad, my public journal: my thoughts on what I'm finding frustrating about the political cycle in Israel, and where we are as a country at the moment.

Corrections

Applied in both files unless marked "edited version only". Times are the start of the transcript paragraph containing the word.

- 00:00 "today is 28th October 2026" → "26th October 2026". This was Daniel's own slip, not a transcription error: recorded 2026-10-26, the day before the 27 October election.
- 00:58 "tipst" → "Typst" (the typesetting program).
- 01:26 "sometimes it's a recurrence space" → "sometimes it's recurring" (edited version only; interpretation).
- 02:14 "it's a forest" → "it's a farce".
- 03:14 "sugbet Knesset" → left as [unclear].
- 04:17 "we will not be in government was this party" → "with this party".

- 06:48 “Eisenhower” → “Eisenkot” (Gadi Eisenkot).
- 08:21 (said at about 08:50) “we told that Andrew” → “we told the landlord”. Likely mishearing; flagged, not confirmed.
- 08:56 “I couldn’t believe state the apart” → left as [unclear] (edited version only; the disfluencies-removed file keeps the wording).
- 13:31 “shekeels” → “shekels”.
- 16:12 “miley” → “mildly”.
- 16:35 “an endless creation” → left as [unclear], possibly “construction” (edited version only).
- 16:49 “digging up that right and center” → “left, right and center”. Inferred from context.
- 16:49 “post a road change” → left as [unclear].
- 22:31 “Betsal El Smotrich” → “Bezalel Smotrich”.
- 22:46 “seeing as ready flags” → “seeing Israeli flags”. Inferred from context.
- 23:19 “gratitious” → “gratuitous”.
- 23:19 Of the US: “a basic level of dysfunction” → “a basic level of function” (edited version only). Daniel clearly means function there; the disfluencies-removed file keeps “dysfunction” as he said it.
- 24:17 “Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago.” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 25:10 “the first time we went to terror” → “Terem” (the Jerusalem urgent-care chain).
- 27:33 “heradium” / “her radium” → “Haredim”.
- 28:18 “fault finding bring” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 29:18 “the Israel icy” → “the Israel I see”.
- 29:18 (said at about 30:05) “the stake and say” → “the state and say”.
- 31:17 “Ben Ver” → “Ben-Gvir”.
- 33:25 “a dismal place to have song” → “sunk”.
- 33:25 “I want in Israel where” → “I want an Israel where”.
- 33:25 “this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that” → partly left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 34:24 “world jury” → “world Jewry”.
- 34:24 “created that inflation” → “conflation”.
- 34:24 “the Jewish people in Israel are different things” → “the Jewish people and Israel are different things”. Inferred from context.
- 34:56 “you can’t criticism” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 37:20 “why is there, we know movement since” → “no movement since”.
- 37:48 “people be on the street for, for that didn’t talk about” → left as [unclear] (edited version only).
- 40:26 “Haredian” → “Haredim”.
- 40:26 “my David Fiducia party” → left as [unclear], possibly “my ideal/dream party”.
- 41:25 “In. In Tron, whatever it was. Tron” → left as [unclear].
- Confirmed correct as transcribed: Maccabi, Arnona, hasbara, aliyah, Herzl, Ben Gurion, OECD, AliExpress, Times of Israel.

What I care about: the rubric

Scoring rubric

Derived from the voice note of 2026-10-26 (`context/voice-notes/2026-10-26-politics/`). Timestamps (`mm:ss`) refer to the **original** recording's timeline, as in `transcript-timed` / the raw transcript; the tidied audio is ~7 minutes shorter. Machine-readable copy: `rubric.json`.

Daniel's ask (40:26–41:30 in the original): define an objective rubric from the issues he prioritises and where he stands on them, score every list running on 27 October 2026, then rank on **Stream A** alone and on **A + B** combined.

- **Stream A** — everyday pain points: rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy, and Israel's global reputation ("a meta issue … everyone bears that in some way").
- **Stream B** — the divisive national issues: security, national identity, Haredi enlistment, judicial reform and the rest. Put "to one side" for the first ranking, not ignored.
- **Meta guide** (40:26–42:08): the party he wants says "this is our programme, it's consultative, we're here to serve you", cards on the table. A party defined by what it is against (or by its leader's grievance) scores low. Bar: a published policy PDF, ideally in all commonly spoken languages.

Each criterion is scored **0–5** against the anchors below. **n/e** (no evidence) is allowed and is scored 0 for A1–A6 (a party with no stated policy on Daniel's top issues has, for his purposes, no policy) and excluded from the denominator for Stream B.

Stream A (weights sum to 100)

ID	Criterion	Weight	Daniel's position (source)	5 =	0 =
A1	Tenant protection and rental reform	30	His biggest issue "and it's not even close"; no major party has serious policy (08:21). Retaliatory termination, tenancy at will, three-day repair rule unenforced, illegal agent fees (08:21–14:14)	Specific, costed tenant-protection policy: minimum lease terms, limits on no-cause/retaliatory eviction, enforcement, agent-fee ban enforced	Nothing, or opposes regulation
A2	Housing affordability for residents	20	Property ladder "near impossible"; luxury and investment towers instead of homes for residents; Jerusalem as case study (14:14–19:33)	Concrete supply/affordability plan aimed at residents (affordable rental, curbs on investment-only stock, young-family routes)	Nothing beyond slogans
A3	Cost of living and competition	20	Everything costs double or triple; anti-competitive market; import limits (AliExpress exemption) a petty own goal (22:22–23:46)	Specific pro-competition and import-liberalisation measures, price/wage plan	Nothing, or protectionist
A4	Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness	15	Utilities/Arnona admin, small-business bureaucracy, urgent	Specific plans for service delivery, digital government,	Nothing

ID	Criterion	Weight	Daniel's position (source)	5 =	0 =
			care that leaves a child unattended, shelters closed or charging for parking (12:04–13:02, 20:28–22:22, 24:17–26:21)	health access, civil defence	
A5	Israel's global reputation	10	International anger "largely justified"; hasbara is not the answer; "the best answer to antisemitism … is to make Israel great" (32:55–36:05)	Substantive plan to repair relations through conduct and policy, not PR	Indifferent or hostile to it
A6	Programme quality and accountability (meta)	5 within A, plus applied as the meta guide	Wants published, coherent, consultative programmes, transparency and accountability, ideally constituency representation (03:26–06:19, 36:56, 40:26–42:08)	Full published platform (PDF), multilingual, costed, plus electoral/ accountability reform	No platform; identity is a person or an "anti-X" stance

A6 carries only 5 points of the A score, but it is also reported as its own column, because it is the clearest test of the meta guide.

Stream B (each 0–5 = alignment with Daniel, equal weights)

ID	Issue	Daniel's position (source)
B1	Haredi enlistment	Yes, the Haredim should serve; no benefits without contribution; no state within a state (19:33–20:28). But a party that *leads* with it is "the same story" (40:26)
B2	Judicial overhaul	"Very, very dangerous, very erosive" (37:20), though out of proportion to the bread-and-butter issues
B3	Netanyahu	"The one person I'm for sure not voting for" (07:25); not a fan at all (26:52)
B4	Far right in government	Ben-Gvir and Smotrich are "extremist racist[s]" the system needs to hold together (31:17)
B5	Palestinian question	Does not rule out a Palestinian state in principle; doesn't see how it can be done; not what holds everything back (32:32)
B6	Security and alliances	A strong Israel that forms alliances where possible (32:09)
B7	Religion and state	Against religious coercion, especially in Jerusalem (16:12)
B8	October 7 accountability	A state commission should exist, but it is not front-line policy (28:49–30:11)
B9	Diaspora and hasbara spending	Contrarian: Israel should not appoint itself guardian of world Jewry or fund public-diplomacy apparatus that "never really shows fruit" (34:24–36:05)

Scores and ranking

- **A score** = Σ(weight × score/5) over A1–A6, 0–100.
- **B score** = mean of the scored B items × 20, 0–100 (n/e excluded; at least 4 items needed, else "insufficient").
- **Combined** = 0.7 × A + 0.3 × B. The 70/30 split is an inference: the note puts Stream A first and calls the B issues important but over-weighted in Israeli politics. Rankings are also shown at 50/50 as a sensitivity check.

- **Disqualifier:** a list running Netanyahu as its PM candidate, or pledged to recommend only him (B3 ≤ 1), is flagged “excluded by stated choice”, ranked but not recommendable.
- Lists with fewer than four scored Stream B items get no combined score; they are ordered by 0.7 × A among themselves.
- **Viability:** the threshold is 3.25%. The note criticises splitter parties that split the vote (28:18). The recommendation table therefore shows each list’s polled seats (mean of polls released 10–22 Oct 2026, from `Israeli-Elections-2026/data/polls/`) next to its score, and recommends among lists that are polling above the threshold, naming a best match below it separately.

Sources and limits

- Party evidence was gathered on 27 October 2026 by research agents (Claude Sonnet) following `research/BRIEF.md`, from party websites and platforms, the Israel Democracy Institute election pages and the Israeli and international press. Each claim in `research/parties/` is labelled confirmed or inferred and cited.
- Scoring was done in one pass by a single agent (Claude Opus) from that evidence, so every list is graded on the same reading of the rubric. Scores are judgements against Daniel’s stated positions, not neutral ratings of the parties.
- Gaps: several party sites refused automated access; some image-only PDFs could not be read; minor lists got a light sweep (2–5 searches each). Where nothing was found, the list scores 0 on that Stream A item. For Daniel’s purposes, a policy that can’t be found is no policy.

Rankings

Stream A only: everyday pain points

Weighted 0–100: tenant protection 30, housing 20, cost of living 20, working state 15, reputation 10, programme quality 5.

#	List	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	A score	Seats
1	Together (B'Yachad)	3	4	5	3	2	3	70	11.9
2	The Democrats	1	3	3	3	4	4	51	9
3	Yisrael Beiteinu	2	3	4	1	–	2	45	7.2
4	Joint List	2	3	1	2	–	2	36	8.1
5	Yashar	1	1	3	2	2	2	34	21.4
6	Amcha Yisrael (excl.)	–	1	3	2	1	2	26	1.3
7	The Reservists and the Economic Party	–	1	3	2	–	1	23	2.1
8	Religious Zionist Party – Zehut (excl.)	0	1	3	1	0	2	21	6.5
9	United Arab List (Ra'am)	–	2	–	2	–	0	14	5.5
10	Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	–	–	2	1	–	2	13	–
11	Shema	–	2	1	–	–	1	13	–
12	Likud (excl.)	0	1	1	1	0	1	12	23.5
13	Haredi Public	–	1	1	1	–	1	12	–
14	Israel First	–	–	1	1	–	1	8	–
15	Betach – Social Security	–	–	1	1	–	1	8	–
16	Pirate Party	–	–	–	1	–	3	6	–
17	Dawn's Light (Orot HaShahar)	–	–	1	–	–	1	5	–
18	United Torah Judaism	0	0	1	–	–	0	4	7.7
19	Shas (excl.)	–	–	1	–	–	0	4	8.2
20	Together We Will Succeed (Beyachad Natzliach)	–	–	–	–	2	–	4	–
21	Garden of Eden (Paradise)	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–
22	Fixing the Electoral and Governing System (HaTikun)	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–
23	New Order	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–
24	Hakahal	–	–	–	–	–	1	1	–
25	Otzma Yehudit (excl.)	–	–	–	–	0	0	0	8
26	Noam (excl.)	–	–	–	–	–	0	0	–
27	Tzomet – Beit Yisrael	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
28	Partnership for Everyone (Ihud Bnei HaBrit)	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
29	The Bible Bloc	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
30	Personal Security (Democtatorship)	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
31	The Color Black – Guarding the World of Torah	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
32	You and I (Ani VeAta)	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
33	Ahi Movement	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
34	Sharshar for Love and Unity of the People	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
35	Tkuma (Derech Hazon VeTkuma)	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
36	Women's Voice	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–
37	Just Law (Mishpat Tzedek)	–	–	–	–	–	–	0	–

Both streams

Stream B = mean alignment on the scored B items × 20 (items with no evidence excluded; fewer than 4 scored = insufficient). (excl.) = runs Netanyahu for PM or pledged to recommend only him; ranked but not recommendable.

#	List	A	B	70/30	50/50	Seats
1	Together (B'Yachad)	70	75	71.5	72.5	11.9
2	The Democrats	51	92.5	63.5	71.8	9
3	Yisrael Beiteinu	45	75	54	60	7.2
4	Joint List	36	72	46.8	54	8.1
5	Yashar	34	75.6	46.5	54.8	21.4
6	United Arab List (Ra'am)	14	80	33.8	47	5.5
7	Amcha Yisrael (excl.)	26	40	30.2	33	1.3
8	The Reservists and the Economic Party	23	45	29.6	34	2.1
9	Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	13	40	21.1	26.5	–
10	Religious Zionist Party – Zehut (excl.)	21	11.4	18.1	16.2	6.5
11	Shema	13	28	17.5	20.5	–
12	Likud (excl.)	12	15.6	13.1	13.8	23.5
13	United Torah Judaism	4	16	7.6	10	7.7
14	Shas (excl.)	4	12	6.4	8	8.2
15	Otzma Yehudit (excl.)	0	8	2.4	4	8
16	Noam (excl.)	0	5	1.5	2.5	–
17	Haredi Public	12	–	–	–	–
18	Israel First	8	–	–	–	–
19	Betach – Social Security	8	–	–	–	–
20	Pirate Party	6	–	–	–	–
21	Dawn's Light (Orot HaShahar)	5	–	–	–	–
22	Together We Will Succeed (Beyachad Natzliach)	4	–	–	–	–
23	Garden of Eden (Paradise)	1	–	–	–	–
24	Fixing the Electoral and Governing System (HaTikun)	1	–	–	–	–
25	New Order	1	–	–	–	–
26	Hakahal	1	–	–	–	–
27	Tzomet – Beit Yisrael	0	–	–	–	–
28	Partnership for Everyone (Ihud Bnei HaBrit)	0	–	–	–	–
29	The Bible Bloc	0	–	–	–	–
30	Personal Security (Democtatorship)	0	–	–	–	–
31	The Color Black – Guarding the World of Torah	0	–	–	–	–
32	You and I (Ani VeAta)	0	–	–	–	–
33	Ahi Movement	0	–	–	–	–
34	Sharshar for Love and Unity of the People	0	–	–	–	–
35	Tkuma (Derech Hazon VeTkuma)	0	–	–	–	–
36	Women's Voice	0	–	–	–	–
37	Just Law (Mishpat Tzedek)	0	–	–	–	–

Raw scores

Every criterion 0–5. – = no evidence found (counts as 0 in Stream A, excluded from Stream B). Criteria: ***A1*** *Tenant protection and rental reform;* ***A2*** *Housing affordability for residents;* ***A3*** *Cost of living and competition;* ***A4*** *Working state: bureaucracy, services, emergency readiness;* ***A5*** *Israel's global reputation;* ***A6*** *Programme quality and accountability (meta)* ***B1*** *Haredi enlistment;* ***B2*** *Judicial overhaul;* ***B3*** *Netanyahu;* ***B4*** *Far right in government;* ***B5*** *Palestinian question;* ***B6*** *Security and alliances;* ***B7*** *Religion and state;* ***B8*** *October 7 accountability;* ***B9*** *Diaspora and hasbara spending.*

List	A1	A2	A3	A4	A5	A6	B1	B2	B3	B4	B5	B6	B7	B8	B9
Together (B'Yachad)	3	4	5	3	2	3	5	3	5	4	2	4	4	3	–
The Democrats	1	3	3	3	4	4	5	5	5	5	4	4	5	4	–
Yisrael Beiteinu	2	3	4	1	–	2	4	4	4	3	3	3	5	4	–
Joint List	2	3	1	2	–	2	–	4	5	5	3	1	–	–	–
Yashar	1	1	3	2	2	2	5	4	5	4	3	5	3	3	2
Amcha Yisrael	–	1	3	2	1	2	3	2	1	1	1	2	3	4	1
The Reservists and the Economic Party	–	1	3	2	–	1	4	2	2	1	1	3	2	3	–
Religious Zionist Party – Zehut	0	1	3	1	0	2	2	0	1	0	0	1	0	–	–
United Arab List (Ra'am)	–	2	–	2	–	0	–	4	5	5	2	–	–	–	–
Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	–	–	2	1	–	2	–	2	–	–	1	–	1	4	2
Shema	–	2	1	–	–	1	4	1	–	–	2	–	0	–	0
Likud	0	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	0	1	3	1	1	0
Haredi Public	–	1	1	1	–	1	1	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–
Israel First	–	–	1	1	–	1	4	–	–	–	–	–	3	–	–
Betach – Social Security	–	–	1	1	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Pirate Party	–	–	–	1	–	3	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Dawn's Light (Orot HaShahar)	–	–	1	–	–	1	–	0	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
United Torah Judaism	0	0	1	–	–	0	0	1	2	1	–	–	0	–	–
Shas	–	–	1	–	–	0	0	1	1	1	–	–	0	–	–
Together We Will Succeed (Beyachad Natzliach)	–	–	–	–	2	–	–	–	–	–	4	–	–	–	–
Garden of Eden (Paradise)	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Fixing the Electoral and Governing System (HaTikun)	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
New Order	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Hakahal	–	–	–	–	–	1	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Otzma Yehudit	–	–	–	–	0	0	–	0	1	0	0	1	–	–	–
Noam	–	–	–	–	–	0	–	0	1	0	–	–	0	–	–
Tzomet – Beit Yisrael	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Partnership for Everyone (Ihud Bnei HaBrit)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
The Bible Bloc	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Personal Security (Democtatorship)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
The Color Black – Guarding the World of Torah	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
You and I (Ani VeAta)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Ahi Movement	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Sharshar for Love and Unity of the People	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Tkuma (Derech Hazon VeTkuma)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Women's Voice	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
Just Law (Mishpat Tzedek)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–

Party profiles

Lists polling at or above the threshold, and the best matches below it. Full evidence with sources: `research/parties/` in the repo.

Together (B'Yachad) (ביחד בראשות נפתלי בנט)

Naftali Bennett · polled seats 11.9 · A 70 · B 75 · combined 71.5

The strongest offer on Daniel's everyday issues: a detailed cost-of-living plan with import liberalisation, a large long-term rental programme and the only landlord incentive for longer leases. It still has nothing on retaliatory eviction, agent fees or enforcement, and Bennett's annexation stance and the 'replace Netanyahu' framing sit poorly with him.

A1	3	Not supply-only: tax benefits for private landlords on 5+ year leases and 'long-term certainty for tenants', plus 100k long-term rental units (40% regulated, 30% below market). Nothing on eviction, retaliation, agent fees or enforcement. Lapid/German co-sponsored the 2017 Fair Rental Law
A2	4	Concrete: 100k long-term rental units in 10 years, lease-purchase after 10 years, urban-renewal and permit timelines. Benefits skewed to reservists; no curbs on investment-only stock
A3	5	Most specific A3 plan of any list: food prices -30% in 3 years, lower import barriers, gradual tariff cuts, break importer monopolies, accept international kosher certification, OECD-average basket target
A4	3	Plan pages exist on health, transport, small businesses and public service, but the evidence file did not read them *(inferred)*
A5	2	Ending regional isolation through alliances; no explicit plan to repair reputation through conduct
A6	3	About 25 web plan pages in Hebrew, English, Russian and Amharic, with some numeric targets; PM term limit and a constitution proposal. No PDF, not costed, no consultation; identity partly 'replace Netanyahu'
B1	5	Mandatory conscription; no state funding for those who don't serve, work or study the core curriculum
B2	3	Regulate Basic Laws and the judiciary 'through broad consensus', constitution proposal: not a pledge to repeal the overhaul
B3	5	Replacing Netanyahu is the list's core purpose
B4	4	Anti-Netanyahu bloc; no explicit ruling-out of Ben-Gvir/Smotrich read *(inferred)*
B5	2	Bennett favours annexing Area C and rejects statehood; Lapid's separation line is subordinate. Joint position unclear
B6	4	Strong security plus regional alliances
B7	4	Bennett backs Shabbat public transport and civil marriage; religion-and-state plan page
B8	3	State commission as the government's first act: Daniel supports one but not as front-line policy
B9	–	Diaspora/aliyah plan pages exist but were not read; no spending position

The Democrats (הדמוקרטים בראשות יאיר גולן)

Yair Golan · polled seats 9 · A 51 · B 92.5 · combined 63.5

The best match on documentation and on almost every Stream B position, with the only substantive plan on Israel's reputation. On rent, its top issue for Daniel, it diagnoses the problem but offers only more long-term rental and public housing, and it leans on price controls rather than competition.

A1	1	Names 'rent that shatters dreams' but the only remedy is to expand long-term rental and affordable public housing: supply-only, no numbers. Meretz's Zandberg co-sponsored the 2017 Fair Rental Law
A2	3	Dense planning near transport, urban renewal, varied unit sizes, expanded affordable public housing; resident-aimed but no numbers
A3	3	Fight food, drug and energy cartels, cut transport fares and out-of-pocket costs; but widens price controls and says nothing on imports
A4	3	Broad: health, welfare, education, public transport, north/south rehabilitation, digital access to justice, more judges. Thin on bureaucracy and civil defence

A5	4	Says Israel is seen as extreme and isolated; proposes a regional initiative with the US and moderate Arab states, Saudi normalisation, IMEC: repair through policy
A6	4	Full 16-page platform PDF (Aug 2026), structured 'five steps per theme'; site in English, Arabic, Russian, Spanish, though the PDF is Hebrew-only. PM term limit, no indicted ministers. Not costed, no consultation
B1	5	Absolute equality of burden, national service for all, stop funding Haredi education networks; not the lead message
B2	5	Repeal all 'regime coup' laws including the judges' committee law
B3	5	Blames Netanyahu governments; 'no indicted PM'; firmly in the opposition bloc *(inferred)*
B4	5	Campaigns against 'the most extreme and religious government in Israel's history'
B5	4	Two states, halt annexation, PA role in Gaza: further than Daniel's 'can't see how', but he does not rule it out in principle
B6	4	Strong military plus regional initiative, Iran isolation
B7	5	Civil marriage and divorce, end Rabbinate monopolies, Shabbat transport, fight religious coercion
B8	4	State commission, implement conclusions; not the lead item
B9	–	Platform PDF silent on diaspora and hasbara

Yisrael Beiteinu (ישראל ביתנו בראשות אביגדור ליברמן)

Avigdor Lieberman · polled seats 7.2 · A 45 · B 75 · combined 54

Strong on competition and religion-and-state, with concrete rental-supply and mortgage numbers. It has no tenant protection and nothing on services or reputation, and it leads with the Haredi draft, the framing Daniel calls 'the same story'.

A1	2	Supply-side rental: 20k long-term rental units a year, rent-to-buy saving 30% of rent; Malinovsky bill for a renter tax credit. No lease or eviction protection
A2	3	Land tenders on build quality not land price, 90% mortgages to 40 years for young couples, rent-to-own; partly service-linked
A3	4	Break monopolies including food, end exclusive importers, deregulate; unfunded per press
A4	1	Fewer ministers and a constitution; no service-delivery, health or civil-defence plan
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	2	Hebrew web platform with concrete items and overlapping older text, no PDF, not costed; constitution, two-term PM limit. Leader-defined party
B1	4	Universal draft, evaders lose benefits; but it leads its campaign with the draft ('same story')
B2	4	Opposes the override clause and 'French law'; proposes a constitutional court
B3	4	Vocal Netanyahu critic; no explicit rule-out in the evidence
B4	3	No direct statement; opposes Haredi parties and Netanyahu coalitions *(inferred)*
B5	3	Regional package deal; past population-swap plan
B6	3	Security-first, bigger defence budget; little on alliances
B7	5	Full separation: civil marriage, Shabbat transport, core studies for funding
B8	4	Promises a state commission (one outlet)
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Joint List (הרשימה המשותפת)

Yousef Jabareen · polled seats 8.1 · A 36 · B 72 · combined 46.8

Has a real published socio-economic programme with the only rent cap of any major list and ambitious public housing. Its trade protectionism runs against Daniel's cost-of-living view, its security position is far from his, and it says nothing on tenant rights beyond the cap.

A1	2	Cap rent at 20% of household net income: a real rent-regulation measure, but nothing on lease security, eviction or agent fees, and no mechanism

A2	3	Guaranteed public housing, interest-free first mortgages, state construction, land for young couples; sweeping and uncosted
A3	1	Wage and VAT plan, but tariffs against imports: protectionist, against Daniel's anchor
A4	2	Free education from 0, long-term care insurance, funded crime plan for Arab towns; nothing on bureaucracy
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	2	Published economic-social web programme in Hebrew and Arabic (English/Russian nav); undated, uncosted, no security platform
B1	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	4	No explicit statement; opposition bloc that fought the overhaul *(inferred)*
B3	5	Supports only a government that replaces Netanyahu
B4	5	Campaigns against 'racism, supremacy'
B5	3	End occupation and settlement funding; further than Daniel, who doubts a state can be done
B6	1	Deep military cuts; no alliances policy: opposite of 'a strong Israel'
B7	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Yashar (ישר! עם איזנקוט לראשות הממשלה מאחדים את ישראל)

Gadi Eisenkot · polled seats 21.4 · A 34 · B 75.6 · combined 46.5

A credible anti-Netanyahu security list whose Stream B positions mostly fit Daniel. On his everyday issues it offers one undetailed phrase on renters, service-linked housing benefits and a generic cost-of-living pledge, and it leads with the October 7 commission and the PM candidate's name: the 'ex-general's party' pattern he describes.

A1	1	Youth package mentions 'assistance and protection mechanisms for renters' with no detail; Folkman (2017 Fair Rental Law author) on the list is a candidate record, not policy
A2	1	Only 'housing benefits' for those who serve and a long-range planning authority; no supply or resident-affordability plan
A3	3	National plan against cost of living: break concentrations, competition, international standards; no targets, nothing on imports
A4	2	Periphery health/transport investment, professional civil service; no bureaucracy or civil-defence plan
A5	2	'Expand peace agreements' within a security strategy; no reputation-repair plan
A6	2	Short 10-point brochure PDF; site in Hebrew, English, Russian; PM term limit. Not costed, no consultation; leader's name in the list title
B1	5	Haredi and Arab service, equal burden; universal national service as a coalition condition
B2	4	Protect rule of law and judicial independence; no specific repeal pledge
B3	5	Rules out serving under Netanyahu, even in rotation
B4	4	No direct statement; rules out a Netanyahu-led coalition *(inferred)*
B5	3	Expand peace agreements, Jewish majority; no statehood position
B6	5	Strengthen the IDF and expand peace agreements: Daniel's 'strong, alliances where possible'
B7	3	'Inclusive Judaism', local autonomy; courts Shas; no civil-marriage or Shabbat-transport pledge
B8	3	State commission is point 1 of 10, the front-line framing Daniel objects to
B9	2	1 million aliyah goal and keeps the Grandchild Clause: diaspora-oriented, no hasbara stance

United Arab List (Ra'am) (רע"ם – הרשימה הערבית המאוחדת)

Mansour Abbas · polled seats 5.5 · A 14 · B 80 · combined 33.8

A pragmatic delivery party for Arab society with no published programme and nothing on rent, cost of living or reputation. Its anti-Netanyahu, anti-Ben-Gvir stance fits Daniel, but there is little else to score.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file
A2	2	Arab-sector housing record (10,000 units in the 2021 deal), opposes demolitions; no general plan
A3	–	No evidence found in the research file
A4	2	Arab-sector crime and infrastructure focus; record of a 20bn NIS infrastructure plan
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	0	No published programme in any language; leader-centred
B1	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	4	No 2026 statement; inferred from its role in the 2021-22 change coalition and the opposition to the overhaul *(inferred)*
B3	5	Rules out partnership with Netanyahu
B4	5	Campaigns against Ben-Gvir
B5	2	Has accepted Israel's Jewish character but refuses to call Hamas a terror organisation; no statehood stance found *(inferred)*
B6	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

The Reservists and the Economic Party (המילואימניקים והכלכלית בראשות יועז הנדל וירון זליכה)

Yoaz Hendel · polled seats 2.1 · A 23 · B 45 · combined 29.6

Pro-competition economics with a reform cadence, but no rent or general housing policy, and its identity is reservist burden-sharing. It polls below the threshold.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file
A2	1	Only perks for those who serve
A3	3	Free economy, fight monopolies, business-barrier task force, three measurable reforms a year; imports not mentioned
A4	2	Regulatory-barrier task force for businesses; nothing on services
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	1	Hebrew principles page only; PM term limit
B1	4	Universal draft, non-servers lose benefits and even the vote: leads with it and goes beyond 'no benefits without contribution'
B2	2	Partial reform: split the AG role, Basic Law: Legislation, 'broad agreement'
B3	2	Netanyahu 'not his red line'; recommends whoever brings most Zionist seats
B4	1	'Zionist government' without Haredi or Arab parties implies the right bloc *(inferred)*
B5	1	Opposes a state; 'voluntary migration directorate'
B6	3	Offensive doctrine; regional cooperation against Iran
B7	2	No budget without service; religious service tracks
B8	3	Investigate all failures; sceptical of the state-commission label
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam) (ברית עולם לגאולת ישראל)

Ofer Pinhas Lifshitz · polled seats – · A 13 · B 40 · combined 21.1

Proposes constituency representation, which Daniel wants, but inside a messianic, annexationist programme with nothing on rent.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file

A2	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	2	Remove VAT on services, committee on bank/insurance fees; favours local over foreign labour
A4	1	Cut surplus government posts
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	2	Hebrew web platform with 12 regional constituencies and a directly elected president: constituency representation Daniel wants, in a messianic frame
B1	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	2	Court reform through a constitution process
B3	–	No evidence found in the research file
B4	–	No evidence found in the research file
B5	1	Cancel Oslo, sovereignty over Judea, Samaria, Gaza
B6	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	1	Governance grounded in a religious covenant *(inferred)*
B8	4	Immediate state commission
B9	2	Urges diaspora Jews to take Law of Return citizenship

Religious Zionist Party – Zehut (הציונות הדתית בראשות בצלאל סמוטריץ' וזהות בראשות משה פייגלין)

Bezalel Smotrich · polled seats 6.5 · A 21 · B 11.4 · combined 18.1 · excluded (Netanyahu)

Smotrich's list. It is the only one that tried to widen personal imports, which is Daniel's own AliExpress example, but it has no rent or housing plan, and its annexation and far-right positions are the opposite of his.

A1	0	Nothing on rent; Zehut's approach is deregulation *(inferred)*
A2	1	Smotrich's Finance record: land tenders and price forecasts; admits housing was not addressed in three years; no resident plan
A3	3	Smotrich twice raised the personal-import exemption (Daniel's AliExpress point) and promised open banking; Zehut would remove import barriers. Record otherwise weak
A4	1	Welfare, health and mental-health PDFs exist but unread; no bureaucracy plan
A5	0	Annexation of the West Bank, Gaza and south Lebanon: hostile to repair
A6	2	Topic-by-topic platform PDFs, mostly carried over from 2021-22, Hebrew only, silent on housing and cost of living
B1	2	Smotrich declined to take a position; several MKs opposed the exemption bill
B2	0	Rothman led the overhaul
B3	1	Netanyahu coalition partner
B4	0	Smotrich is one of the two Daniel names
B5	0	Nullify Oslo, annex, encourage emigration
B6	1	War in the West Bank, annex to the Litani; no alliances
B7	0	Jewish identity and family-law platform; religious-nationalist *(inferred)*
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	Diaspora/aliyah PDF exists but not read

Shema (שמע בראשות נפתלי גולדמן)

Naftali Goldman · polled seats – · A 13 · B 28 · combined 17.5

A one-candidate religious-moral list with an interesting army-base housing idea, but it is coercive on religion.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file
A2	2	Move army bases out of cities to free land for 'hundreds of thousands' of homes; subsidised for under-35 servers
A3	1	Support for vulnerable groups; no competition policy
A4	–	No evidence found in the research file

A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	1	One-man list's web platform on a non-party domain
B1	4	Universal conscription of Jewish men, no exemption
B2	1	Limit the Supreme Court's power to strike laws
B3	–	No evidence found in the research file
B4	–	No evidence found in the research file
B5	2	Opposes two states
B6	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	0	Religiously coercive
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	0	Diaspora minister 'with significant budget'

Likud (הליכוד בהנהגת בנימין נתניהו לראשות הממשלה)

Benjamin Netanyahu · polled seats 23.5 · A 12 · B 15.6 · combined 13.1 · excluded (Netanyahu)

Runs Netanyahu, the one candidate Daniel will not vote for, and offers no rent, housing or cost-of-living programme beyond generic principles and its own record. Excluded by his stated choice.

A1	0	No tenant policy; held Housing since June 2025 with no tenant measure
A2	1	Housing named under 'society and periphery' with no specifics; claims a 1.2% price fall
A3	1	Electricity reform claimed; Likud MKs helped revoke the personal-import exemption raise (Daniel's AliExpress example)
A4	1	Holds Health and Interior; Comptroller found no body managing Iran-war evacuation and a third of residents without shelter
A5	0	Answer is a quadrupled hasbara budget: the PR approach Daniel rejects
A6	1	Six generic principles plus self-reported achievements on a multilingual site; leader-centred
B1	1	Bismuth bill keeps full-time yeshiva exemptions
B2	0	Passed the judicial selection laws
B3	0	Netanyahu is the PM candidate
B4	0	Governed with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich and urged them to reunite
B5	1	Settlement and sovereignty
B6	3	Strong security record claimed; alliances stated, isolation in practice
B7	1	Concessions to Haredi parties on funding and the draft
B8	1	Blocks a state commission; backed a politically appointed one
B9	0	$730m public diplomacy; Diaspora ministry

United Torah Judaism (יהדות התורה והשבת אגודת ישראל – דגל התורה)

Ya'akov Asher · polled seats 7.7 · A 4 · B 16 · combined 7.6

A sectoral list whose only stated demand is a draft-exemption law. Its housing ministry record is negative for Daniel and it has no platform.

A1	0	Held Housing (Goldknopf, 2022-25) and produced no tenant legislation
A2	0	Housing minister unsure there was a crisis; repurposed general-public projects for Haredim
A3	1	Pushed a VAT cut to 17%; no competition policy
A4	–	No evidence found in the research file
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	0	No platform found
B1	0	Exemption for all full-time yeshiva students, no sanctions

B2	1	In the coalition when the judicial selection law passed *(inferred)*
B3	2	Says it belongs to no bloc; earlier backed Netanyahu
B4	1	Sat in government with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich *(inferred)*
B5	–	No evidence found in the research file
B6	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	0	Funding and autonomy for yeshivas and schools
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Shas (התאחדות הספרדים שומרי תורה תנועתו של מרן הרב עובדיה יוסף זצ"ל)

Aryeh Deri · polled seats 8.2 · A 4 · B 12 · combined 6.4 · excluded (Netanyahu)

A sectoral party whose stated purpose is a draft-exemption law and institutional funding. No platform and nothing on rent or housing; only an arnona-discount record touches Daniel's issues.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file
A2	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	1	Arnona-discount expansion under a Shas Interior minister (attribution inferred): relief, not competition *(inferred)*
A4	–	Held Health and Interior; no service or urgent-care policy found
A5	–	No evidence found in the research file
A6	0	No platform found
B1	0	Will not join a government without an exemption law
B2	1	In the coalition that passed the judicial selection law *(inferred)*
B3	1	Long-time Netanyahu partner; conditions are on the draft, not on him
B4	1	Sat with Ben-Gvir and Smotrich *(inferred)*
B5	–	No evidence found in the research file
B6	–	No evidence found in the research file
B7	0	Seeks Orthodox character and Haredi institution funding
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Otzma Yehudit (עוצמה יהודית בראשות איתמר בן גביר)

Itamar Ben-Gvir · polled seats 8 · A 0 · B 8 · combined 2.4 · excluded (Netanyahu)

Ben-Gvir's list, which Daniel names as extremist and racist. No platform and nothing on any Stream A issue.

A1	–	No evidence found in the research file
A2	–	No evidence found in the research file
A3	–	No evidence found in the research file
A4	–	Ben-Gvir ran National Security; no civil-defence or service plan found either way
A5	0	Encouraging Palestinian emigration and the death penalty for terrorists would deepen the damage *(inferred)*
A6	0	No platform; leader-led, demands ministries
B1	–	No evidence found in the research file
B2	0	Fire the attorney general, radically weaken the judiciary
B3	1	Netanyahu-bloc partner, though it runs separately
B4	0	Is the far right Daniel names
B5	0	Encourage Palestinians to leave Gaza and the West Bank
B6	1	Looser military constraints; no alliances

B7	–	No evidence found in the research file
B8	–	No evidence found in the research file
B9	–	No evidence found in the research file

Recommendations by match

Bottom line. On the rubric built from my voice note, the best match among lists polling above the threshold is **Together (Bennett–Lapid), ballot letters רק**, followed by **The Democrats (אמת)** and **Yisrael Beiteinu (ל)**. The order of the top three is the same on Stream A alone, at 70/30 and at 50/50. Fourth and fifth (Joint List, Yashar) swap places at 50/50.

The headline finding is a gap. No list on the ballot has a real tenant-protection policy, my top issue. The best A1 score is 3 out of 5 (Together, for tax incentives on leases of five years or more). Nobody proposes limits on no-cause or retaliatory eviction, enforcement of repair duties, or enforcement of the agent-fee ban. That is what I suspected in the note (08:21): "not a single major party … had bothered to articulate any serious policy for" it. It is still true on election day.

The top five, with reasons:

1. **Together (רק): 71.5.** The strongest Stream A offer: the most detailed cost-of-living plan (import and tariff liberalisation with price targets), 100,000 long-term rental units, and the only measure aimed at lease length. Weaker on Stream B than the Democrats (Bennett's annexation stance), and its identity is partly "replace Netanyahu".
2. **The Democrats (אמת): 63.5.** The closest match on almost every Stream B issue, the best-documented programme (a 16-page platform PDF), and the only real plan on Israel's reputation. On rent it diagnoses the problem but offers only more public and long-term rental housing. On prices it leans on price controls rather than competition.
3. **Yisrael Beiteinu (ל): 54.0.** Concrete rental-supply and mortgage numbers, and strong on competition (ending exclusive importers) and on religion and state. Nothing on tenant protection, services or reputation, and it leads with the Haredi draft, the framing I call "the same story".
4. **Joint List (ודם): 46.8.** The only rent cap of any major list (20% of household income) and a published socio-economic programme. Its trade protectionism and its security positions are far from mine.
5. **Yashar (דרך): 46.5.** Polls second overall and fits me on Stream B, but on everyday issues it offers one undetailed phrase on renters. It leads with the October 7 commission and its leader's name: the ex-general's party pattern from the note.

Lists running Netanyahu for PM, or pledged to recommend only him, are excluded by my stated choice (Likud, Shas, Otzma Yehudit, RZP–Zehut, Noam, Amcha Yisrael). The best match below the threshold is the Reservists and the Economic Party (about 2 seats in recent polls).

These are judgements against my own stated positions, made by AI agents from public evidence gathered on election day. They are not a neutral rating of the parties. Every score has a written reason in the party profiles and in `data/scores.json`.

Lists that pass the threshold, best match first

Combined score = 0.7 × Stream A + 0.3 × Stream B (0–100). Lists running or pledged to recommend only Netanyahu are excluded by Daniel's stated choice and not shown here. Polled seats: mean of polls released 10–22 Oct 2026.

#	List	Ballot	Combined 70/30	Combined 50/50	Stream A	Stream B	Polled seats
1	**Together (B'Yachad)** Naftali Bennett	**רק**	71.5	72.5	70	75	11.9
2	**The Democrats** Yair Golan	**אמת**	63.5	71.8	51	92.5	9
3	**Yisrael Beiteinu** Avigdor Lieberman	**ל**	54	60	45	75	7.2
4	**Joint List** Yousef Jabareen	**ודם**	46.8	54	36	72	8.1
5	**Yashar** Gadi Eisenkot	**דרך**	46.5	54.8	34	75.6	21.4

#	List	Ballot	Combined 70/30	Combined 50/50	Stream A	Stream B	Polled seats
6	**United Arab List (Ra'am)** Mansour Abbas	עם	33.8	47	14	80	5.5
7	**United Torah Judaism** Ya'akov Asher	ג	7.6	10	4	16	7.7

Best matches polling below the threshold

A vote here is likely to be lost unless the list crosses 3.25% (about 4 seats).

List	Combined 70/30	Stream A	Stream B	Polled seats
The Reservists and the Economic Party	29.6	23	45	2.1
Eternal Covenant (Brit Olam)	21.1	13	40	–
Shema	17.5	13	28	–

Appendix · Raw transcript

Okay, so today is 28th October 2026, the day before the elections in Israel. And I, like many people in Israel, feel very disillusioned, disenfranchised with the entire political system. But I turn to you Claude, in order to create a guide tailored to my own voting what I'm looking for in a party, as it were. So I'll set out in this voice note which will be in a public repository. The which is intentional, in case you're asking.

So we'll do our usual process of sending this for. Sending this audio file for transcription, then getting a cleaned up version and please keep the audio file, the binary in the. In the repo and just link to it in the readme in case anyone wants to actually hear the original for chain of custody. This is just if. No, can't think of any reason why.

But it's a demonstration, I guess, of a voice to research workflow that I do a lot in which I'll use a voice note to record a lengthy research brief and get all the details in and then I'll send Claude off to do his Claude like thing. And then usually I'll try. I'll. I'll pair that with some kind of an output skill which I typically tend to use tipst. I keep thinking I'm pronouncing it wrong.

The typesetting program, which is just fantastic tool. So I'll usually then round out the skill by saying, Claude, summarize your research in a PDF, bake it into a PDF, put it to my Google Drive, send it to me by email. And that's kind of the life cycle of a research repository. Sometimes once off, sometimes it's a recurrence space. So this one is just a public, public demo and sometimes I'll generate a podcast from it.

So this one, I might also create a podcast episode too, as sometimes I prefer to listen to what Claude finds and. Or both. They're complementary. Okay, so here is the. Here is basically my feelings on the current state of affairs in Israel.

So my long standing critique of Israeli politics is. And I'm recording this actually looking at the Israeli Parliament building from outside of a window here. Not metaphorically speaking, literally. I can see it from where I'm recording this and when I look upon it, I feel this feeling of disgust that rises from an institution that has become so far divorced from any mandate of serving citizens, that it's unimaginable that this, this house is a, it's a forest, it's not representing the interests of Israeli, the Israeli Electorate. It's a, it's a collection of self important people infighting, people abusing the name of the Knesset, the institution in, in ancient Israel and some of the manifestations of it, the 120 seats and it's a slight on the old institution.

It's a, it's a Knesset of, it's a sugbet Knesset, whatever you want to call it.

And you know, the, in the litany of things that I feel is broken and wrong with Israeli politics, I feel it stems from one very fundamental. There's one rotten root to it which is that in the way this country is set up, our electoral system here there is no accountability baked into the system and we have an electorate that accepts this because this is the way things are here and Israelis are at once. Is my external critique as someone who moved here from, from Ireland at once very worldly and sometimes also peculiar. Peculiarly, peculiarly. I'm having a hard time with some words today in a peculiar way insular in the sense that, you know, this is their frame of reference and this is how politics are done here.

And my frame of reference, having grown up in Ireland, which has, you know, its own pros and cons about its political system, but at least one of the good things you can say about it is that because you have a politician you vote for at the national elections for an electoral area and there is theoretically someone you can complain to or you know, contact to get, to get representation and we have this completely broken political system here in which there is, because of the design of the, of the political system, we have incentivized an extremely fractured and divisive political system that is characterized by repetitive breakaway alliances that are splitting votes and which are often less often created in order to, you know, create genuinely interesting ideological propositions and coherent platforms and more often because some person didn't get the, the slate that they thought that was becoming to them and therefore they decided I'm going to form a breakaway party or the party exists because one of its core principles is we will not be in government was this party. And the commonality here is that none of these expressions articulate anything about what, what this party is going to do for the electorate or the people. That's the fundamental problem as I see it, with Israeli politics. So, you know, I've been kind of reading naturally about who's running in this upcoming election and trying to even summon up the, the motivation to do that because it's exhausting. What there's like three more political parties, four more, five More from the last time.

Why? Who? And the first question you'd ask about any of them is, well, what do they stand for that's going to actually benefit my life. And all you read about in the news has nothing to do with that. The political system that we have here in Israel creates because the Israeli electorate is itself so divided in this system.

The only way to. The way which, the way in which parties differentiate themselves is by differentiating upon the slice of the electorate that they pander to instead of collective issues. And the reason I feel so profoundly disillusioned about the political situation in Israel is that, you know, I could say, okay, well, hopefully Netanyahu will not be elected. That's the one person I'm for sure not voting for. When people say, well, what about Eisenhower, what about this party, that party?

I say, it's the same problem. That's what. That's where, you know, I will be even more pessimistic than some people here because I'll say, yeah, it's more of the same. Can't you see that there parties who are saying we were, we will, we demand that the Haredim draft exemption will end the judicial reform and the issues that matter to me in my 10 years living in the state of Israel as an immigrant who moved here from Ireland, by the greatest detrimental thing or the biggest issue in my life, and it's not even close, is an issue that last time I checked, not a single major party running in this election had bothered to articulate any serious policy for. And that is tenant protection law.

I spent the majority of June, July, it's all a blur this summer, basically self moving an apartment. And we did that because our previous landlord, we had a leak, woke up one day to find that there was water dripping on my bed. And when I asked after two weeks, you know, we told that Andrew on the day when I said, so are you gonna fix it? He came the next day and then sent us this. You know, it was very pleasant.

Of course I'm gonna get a fix. I'm gonna get right on it. And then followed up the next day with an extremely angry, I couldn't believe state the apart and basically retaliatory termination of the lease. And we had, you know, our son is now 15 months old. the time was much younger.

We were sleeping as a family on the couch because our room, I mean, it got to the point where there was mold growing on the, on the roof. I was sending the landlord video updates being like, for your sake, not mine, you probably want to like, get on this asap because your. Your place is being ruined. You know, I got. Literally did everything in my power to.

To make it happen. And it's a. It's a. It's something that the law says they have three days to do it. And of course, he just didn't do it, because what's the point of having a law if there is absolutely no consequence to it?

And if people. What's the point of having a law if people are. If. The lesson that. The chilling effect of my story that reverberates out through our friends and through my colleagues and the rest is that don't dare exercise even the minimal laws you.

The rights you have, because the landlord will just decide not to renew your lease. And because we have tenancy at will, he can say, yeah, I just decided not to. You know, even though this was a very clear example of a retaliatory lease, it made absolutely no difference. And we found this turned into a. But this.

This is the hot issue that gets me hot under the collar. We consulted with a lawyer, and he was very unpleasant. We couldn't fix. We. We asked to.

Even we. We were like, trying to explain to the man that we need. He's like, yeah, just okay, if you don't want to stay here, just leave. And we're like, okay, but, like, you do realize that we need a roof over our heads. Like, I don't know if that point was like, lost in translation there, Mr. Landlord.

So when we went to our lawyer, we kind of got the same reaction. And we're both like, my wife and I, okay, we're just going to tell you what finding a place to live in Jerusalem is like at the moment. It means you go for viewings after viewing, after viewing, you have to play. You have to firstly pay an illegal agency. Because every single agent has cornered the market in basically a scam that frustrated the previous attempt at creating tenancy law.

It's an illegal thing that they found this ridiculous workaround for, and de facto you have to pay it. That's one month's rent plus VAT to the agent fee. So when you find a new place, if you find a new place, you're looking at your weekend spent trudging around with a. With a young baby. Neither of us have family in Israel.

Going in, you know, in the heat of the summer to see the depressing places. We even found that some of the listings, this was. This was the. This was the. The kind of pinnacle of it.

They began new trends, started saying this image on listings you'd see, like, image was enhanced with artificial intelligence. So you're like, wait, okay, so this is like an AI image of the place that you're posting. And the last move was astronomically expensive. You have to disconnect all the utilities from the landlord's name because the local municipality in Jerusalem, in all its infinite wisdom, which it's, you know, with which it exerts itself digging up the city

and making this place chaos, has not actually come up with any workable system for tenants to pay their Arnona, the highest one in the country, in a way that doesn't incur a yearly obligation to them on a property they don't own. So you have to literally do unpaid admin work for the landlord to get yourself and also to get yourself off the hook for paying somebody else's municipal bill plus electricity, plus water, plus the rest of it.

Then in the next place, you've the pleasure of doing all of this again. So the last time we moved, similar story. This landlord was a lot nicer, but we lost the place after paying rent every single month on time. The rest of it, because he wanted to give his apartment away to his daughters. So I can't even describe, like, the cumulative, the mental sense of like.

Like loss of stability. A deep, a profound sort of like when you don't feel like you have a place and we're working, we're putting, we're saving. Where my wife's an architect, I work in tech, and we're looking at the spreadsheets and we're like, A, it doesn't really matter because the numbers just don't seem to check out that we can do this. And B, even if it did, even if we were doing everything in our power to get on the property ladder and the rest of it and living off beans and rice, I don't think we'd have anything to show for it because every time we do this, like, the Last move was 10,000 shekels. The next move was 10,000 shekeels time off work.

This one, I literally moved half our boxes ourselves. So if you're listening, if anyone ever listens to this or reads a transcript and you're hearing a man rant for 10 minutes about how I spent my summer trying to parent a toddler while moving boxes to do as much of the move as I could, because between all these expenses and deposits and agent fees, we literally, to ensure cash flow, had to have a cheap move. That's when I look around and say, how is the state? This is. This is Just like that's the biggest setback to.

For me, the Jewish vision of every Jewish person moving to Israel and having a place to live here and prospering. I'm like, yeah, but like we.

The cost of living and the rest of it is such that getting on their property ladder is near impossible.

I can't. If I had literally, if my hourly rate were multiplied by the amount of hours that I spent tearing up ethernet cables in a previous rental, but to put them back down in the next one, packing boxes, unpacking boxes, moving boxes, finding, finding place for things, starting unboxing. Like to do that with a family, I would be. My bank account would be in a much better state than it was now. Put it like that.

So that's been. Mentally, spiritually, personally. The drain that is like sucked so much of what's good about this country and turned it into frustration and anger and cynicism. It's that other things, honestly, not so much. I actually enjoy living here.

The people are great. I love the food. You know, I adapt to the culture. The tech is amazing. There's so much that's good here.

The bad thing, you know, religious extremism, I find in Jerusalem, I don't like that it's becoming coercive. I'm not a fan of Jerusalem, to put it miley these days at least. Or I'm very. Let's say I'm less optimistic about the city than I ever have been or more pessimistic. But that issue as well is just.

It's like a case study in how to mismanage a city. What's happening at the moment, an endless creation. It's sheer greed. It's absolutely. It's catastrophic.

It's. The city is basically just digging up that right and center to create this enormous glut of high rises, turning a blind eye to the fact that half of them are just for investment properties or people who won't live here, while people actually living in the city are literally watching these out of place big skyscrapers going up that they won't be able to afford to live in. And no one's even bothering to post a road change. And we're like, this city is like a joke. Like, seriously, like, who.

Who's actually. You read about the. The cable car going to the old city. You're like, that was the front news today on the Times of Israel. And you're like, who's calling the shots in this place?

Because they do not have their heads screwed on. The city needs the poorest city in Israel, this place needs jobs, incentives for creating jobs. We don't need luxury housing, crazy investment properties. We need coherent, accessible, affordable housing. And, and you can't just plonk people in housing without creating at least some basic scaffolding for an economy here.

And you look at the resources the city puts into that and it's atrocious, it's minimal. I don't blame any VC or investor from, you know, from not really being so hot on the Jerusalem pitch. A city best known these days for religious extremism and riots and. Yeah, no, I don't like anyway, so that, that despite all that negativity, I think Jerusalem is the capital of the Jewish world and the city deserves so much better than this and should be such a more inclusive, affordable and accessible place in this. And I use all those adjectives together.

So the anger comes from my feeling that this is just a microcosm of what's gone wrong in this country, that something nice about it. The good things about the city, about Jerusalem, the slower pace of life compared to Tel Aviv, the fact that people are a bit, you know, less maybe so stylish. I like that. I really like that. Actually, I'm not a, you know, I'm not a very ostentatious person.

But when that gets, what's happening now, the stagnation of the long term residents in the city center and this artificial glut of construction for people who will parachute in here for a few weeks a year, don't speak Hebrew, don't want to interact with people like what kind of a recipe for coherence in a city, in a capital city is that? It's a disaster. So where was I? Where should I pick up this rant?

So when I look at the, what everyone's jockeying over, do I think that the haredim, the ultra religious, should serve in the army? Yes.

I think the social contract can't exist like this. You can't have an internal state within a state. You have to have some basic commonality within the state that the rule of law is the rule of law and you don't get benefits if you don't contribute. So many people, I can say from our own experience as well, there's no. If you're a struggling young family working and being beaten down by agent fees and slumlords and all the stuff we can talk about from personal experience ad nauseam, there is essentially no help.

When the war with Iran broke out, I feel like the. I just, I was kind of in disbelief. That was long. That was A long war. The one earlier this year was it five weeks.

And you know, you wake up one day, a siren goes off at three in the morning or whatever, whatever time it started. And you're like, oh, oh crap. Like what's going on? And then I'm kind of a prepper or have become a prepper. You're like, well, everything's planned, right?

Like the shelters are open and they're not. And at the time, in our old place, like many buildings, we did not have a public shelter. And it's a litany of like, there's no map, there's no interactive map. When war broke out, they weren't open.

I contributed a router to a shelter that got stolen. We got a. It's a parking ticket after the last war. That was crazy. After the ceasefire, the shelter was a car park, literally.

City run shelter was the designated. Sorry, city run car park was a designated shelter, deep shelter. And ceasefire was announced and we were charged for like I think an hour or two of parking, exit fee. And you're like, what? For sheltering an emergency?

Like, are you serious? So it's just things like this. I'm like, what has this state become? Like, how did, how did we go from this collectivist, idealistic poor, but like wholesome society to this thing? Because like this is not a.

You know what I mean? Like these dynamics are just like, they're, they're bigger than any one thing. These are just the little things that I notice. But so okay, to be more, to be more coherent. Like what, what things affect me in my personal life day to day.

The cost of living. No one seems to be doing anything about it. Like the fact that they had this tax exemption for AliExpress. How petty can you be? Everything here is overpriced.

It's always been overpriced. The competition, it's anti competitive. And some guy, Betsal El Smotrich, the right wing guy, introduces like raises the limit and they put it back. You're like, what a miserable government. This is literally like, come on.

Like that, that's how. That's the AliExpress is the escape valve for the Israeli economy. I'm convinced. It's like you realize everyone is buying. Go on to AliExpress listing in any listing and you're like, you're like seeing as ready flags.

You're like, wait, is this like everyone buying everything from this? And you ask your friends and you're like, oh yeah, that's so like we're all doing this because everything here, it costs like Double or triple what it does abroad. And like, it's. And there's no warranty. Or when you try to get your warranty, there's no warranty service.

Like, it's all this just. It's all this dysfunctionalism. When I go to the US or visit the US with my in laws, I appreciate that they have, you know, so many internal divisions and debates in the us but the biggest thing that's like a breath of fresh air when I visit the US Is the feeling that there is a basic level of dysfunction. There's a basic level of dysfunction here that just feels like, gratitious. You're like, it does not need to be this way.

Like life does. Like, you're. It's like you're trying to make life hard. It's like the delivery driver who, who gets irate. A bad example.

But whether it's the bureaucracy for small business, it just feels like it's like when that layer is removed, you're like, oh, well, stuff, actually. Oh, this is pretty nice. Other things I noticed recently. So our son, we had to go to ER twice in the course of the last month. We had a pretty rough month.

Our son just started. His began well a couple of months ago. So I have asthma, and I have very vivid memories of having an asthma attack as a kid. So Ezra comes down with the cold. We come down with the cold.

We're all there, miserable in bed, and suddenly he's really, really having a hard time breathing, right? So we're like, oh, this is pretty scary. We bring him to the doctor. The doctor says, this is our health fund. Prescribes Ventolin nebulizer.

We're like, okay, great. So we get that, we do it. And in middle of the night, we're like, this is not working. He's getting worse. Like, you can see, like, his neck.

He's like pulling his neck. We're like, okay, this is like, we. I don't feel good. Just like staying here. So we call our health fund Maccabi.

And basically, I can't remember the first time we went to terror. Like, I don't think they answered. So by the time we got to urgent care, there's no, like, the helpline says it's not emergency response.

And the second time, which was more recently, was just much, much. That was terrible. So we went there to this urgent care place, which I. I won't name, which. Same story, same pattern exactly. And they say, his oxygen is a bit low.

We need to give him oxygen. We go into the room and we're just left there 20, 30 minutes, he throws up, nobody comes. And we're like trying to, there's no one working there. And my wife and I are like, what do we do? It's like supposed to just like wait here, like they've just told us.

And he was refusing oxygen, like he wouldn't, he wouldn't put it up to his, you know, his face. So we went to the er. They were great. And we met another family there who had the exact same situation. They were like, yeah, we just don't go there anymore.

So the healthcare system, the vaunted healthcare system, which I appreciate in large areas is good, that's a problem. So I read about judicial reform. I read about whether Netanyahu is suitable to stay in government because of the corruption allegations about a few cigars. And I say the first thing sometimes, you know, this is, everyone says this, but there was a time, if I said this before, it wasn't with conviction. Now I can say with conviction.

I'm not a Netanyahu fan at all. I really believe he's, I think, like, whatever, I don't think it's constructive. And that's my issue with Israeli politics. You can, you can just say it's become obsessed with the minutiae of his rule and these issues about the haredim draft, the judicial reform.

Before we create 10 splinter parties and we debate these grand issues in a country without a constitution.

I just wonder every single time how is it that we have a political system whereby electoral cycle after electoral cycle, parties can basically stand up with essentially no platform, coherent platform policy, platform research backed platform targeting the burning issues, OECD math scores. I mean, there's a list of them. And instead we, we see it as like, well, we're going to create a new party that's going to be anti heradium. This one's going to be like pro her radium. This one's going to be a mixture.

And, and I think it's, it's across the board.

The fact that it's accepted by the people who will vote for these parties and that there's so much fractionalism and self interest that they can't learn the lessons of what happened to the destruction of the left and see that in their rush to create new splinter parties, they're splitting the vote and harming the collective interest. But no one, including the voters. And the organizers say, like the October 7th Commission of Inquiry fault finding bring. Okay, I mean that, that was horrific. It was a tragedy.

It was horrible. Of course there should be a State commission of inquiry. But is that, is that the, is that the most important? That's not a policy. That shouldn't be frontline policy.

We're for state commission of inquiry into October 7th. That's a security, I mean two potentially I think useful reasons for that. One, security review, improve, learn lessons and improve. That's a task for the security bodies. Two, culpability.

So there has to be punishments. And if that can, if that doesn't exist, then there's a more fundamental issue. But an independent commission, I just don't understand what that is supposed to achieve or do for the benefit of this whole state and this whole country. It seems like a very strange reaction to this horrible attack that this is going to eclipse everything else because the Israel icy that's tearing itself asunder, that's dog eat dog where people, young people who, who move here, you know, make aliyah to come to Israel can be kicked out of a apartment because there's a property boom and the landlord decides he wants to cash in and they're on the, on the, on the pavement and the stake and say there's. That's, that's just the way it is.

I feel like those are more important issues that, like those, those fixes would be more widely beneficial than any. The, the results of any state inquiry into October 7th could be. So I find myself looking at the one party after the other, the old ones and the jaded pattern of ex generals and I just see, you know, creating their own party, just see another iteration of the exact same problem. The, the root, the, the rotten root, the total lack of, the lack of a political system that views the electorate is there to represent people that big issues, policy related to security, questions of national identity need national consensus in a constitution and in the tradition of democracy I grew up in, a referendum. Those can be those big issues, of course important and they are of course going to delineate between parties.

But there is a complete and utter lack of focus on the bread and butter, to use that really, you know, trite analogy. And the Israel that I like personally is an Israel where hard working people can do well, can afford to have a good life here to vacation in Israel without it being, you know, four times the cost of a cheap getaway in Europe. And of course the, the national issues. Israel's reputation is in the gutter because we have a, whatever, whatever this rotten system of government is that requires a extremist racist like Ben Ver and Smotrich and the others to hold this together.

Like it's just it's, it's hard to articulate, which is why I'm probably gonna have to cut some audio here at this part of the note. But I hope this explains where I feel what I care about personally. You know, what I want to see is a, is an Israel that is strong, that forms alliances where possible.

The Palestinian question, I, I will just say that I, I don't rule out a Palestinian state as a principle. I just don't see any way that it can be done and any, I don't think that's what's holding everything back.

I think that Israel's reaction to October 7th has created enormous and I think honestly largely justified international rage and disgust and the government has done nothing to. All we do is just fund more hasbara. Let's, let's, let's fire some more propaganda. And the world is, the world is like tired of it. And Netanyahu comes out with, after telling us that Iran's being contained like he did last summer, suddenly retweeting an image of a bomb over Tel Aviv.

So we're like what kind of integrity is that? What kind of, what kind of leaders like how low have we sunk from the days of wholesome people like Ben Gurion that this is, this is just what passes other people in the Likud actually see it for that or just kind of laugh and say well that's just electioneering but it's a dismal, it's a dismal place to have song. So I want in Israel where the people who thoughtful people not doesn't have to be technocrats but committed people furthering their collective good, peace and prosperity and focusing on Israel for once. Everything seems to be externalized for some reason. That's what I've noticed where the world, the global reputation is tanking and we're focused on building bridges with the Jewish Diaspora.

My long term term philosophy here, contrarian again is that should not be in scope. If Israel's fighting the view that the, that the Jewish people in Israel are different things. And I, I agree there's a, there's a portion of world jury who aren't Zionist then if you say on the other hand, well we're appointing ourselves the global protector and represent and guardian of world Jews. You've just created that inflation so you can't then turn around and say you've. I think it's unfair frankly.

And I don't think in a country with the kind of health care that exists at least in parts here, we should be doing that. You know, Israel was founded in 1948. If Jewish communities abroad aren't interested in moving here, I would say why, why, why should we maintain this apparatus for these other big tranches of public waste, the efforts to combat anti Semitism, the efforts for public diplomacy that never really show fruit and create this national obsession with how the world sees us that is kind of almost glaringly, I just don't think serves any, any good. I think the best answer to anti Semitism and anti Israelism is to make Israel great. And I don't believe that everything, you can't, you can't criticism, you can't, you know, you can't create a world where everyone likes you.

And we've just see so many, so many good things here and also so many challenges I think are we've got a full caseload of stuff to work on in this country and building up this country and making this country what it should be. And we've got basically a waste of time, political leadership, political class that's asleep at the wheel. I think the economy and country is driven by the talent and, and, and skill of, of everyone else, including the army for that matter. And I think the politicians are just what they are. And we need a radically, radically reformed political system, radical improvement in transparency, programs for government that are coherent.

And the meta thing is a move away from issues of. Because there'll always be these issues for people to, for parties to argue about the political, the security situation, if that never changes. But that's all we, that's all we view as whether we're coming from the left or the right, that that's what it's legitimate for a party to articulate policy about. Then we'll never get past security. And that's what's happening.

You know, the cottage cheese protest, the housing protest. That's ancient history in comparative terms now why is there, we know movement since look at, look at the numbers. Situation's not getting better and yet we're all up in arms about judicial reform. Very, very dangerous, very erosive. But at least can we be consistent with the stuff we actually, you know, if it was in proportion to what it's actually going to affect people.

I think people be on the street for, for that didn't talk about wealth inequality, intergenerational wealth differences in Israel. That's a huge issue. And I think a lot of it, a lot of the disconnect from the political class and why they're so content arguing about anything but rent is that most of the political class in Israel belong to old Families who have a lot of property and like many old Israeli families have an investment stream of that's being funded by newcomers and I just think it's such a. It's such a perversion of the Zionist idealist. This was not, this was not how the idea of a Jewish state where every Jewish person had a home and it could have a dignified life here, this was not.

I can't imagine that this was anything like what Herzl intended. So that's who I. That's all I can get off my chest in these 40 minutes before the election. And what I look what I like from you Claude, is I am part writer, part data, part time, part time data nerd. So I'd like to do this systematically.

You can take that lump of thought that I provided and give some coherence to it. And then I'd like to I've already created a data set for the parties on Hugging Face the lists, who's on the list and I'd like you to give me a. Let's do it like this. Let's define a objective rubric for judging the parties according to the issues that I assign priority to and where I stand on those. Then one by one let's review each party, let's give them a score and then let's stratify this analysis based upon alignment with what I would call my socioeconomic and non divisive I mean none not let's put security nation states, haredi enlistment, let's put those in to one side for the moment let's call that stream B issues and stream A issues are the less contentious things I see as the everyday pain points facing Israeli citizens and I've given just a few examples rent, housing instability, cost of living, bureaucracy and and I would actually put in Israel's global reputation in that because on the one hand it's a meta issue, on the other it's one that trickles.

Everyone bears that in some way or another I believe.

Let's call those A and I'd like to firstly rank the parties from most best match to lowest match just on that axis and then on both axis so split 2 will be alignment together and then you can give me a analysis with your with the summary of the of the party's positions and I will say as one meta guide, one high level guide to what I'm looking for is really my David Fiducia party the mission we're here not because we demand a commission of inquiry for October 7th because we say the Haredian must serve that language, whether I agree with it or not, immediately alienates me because I say it's the same next version of the same story. The last 10 elections, 2026 edition. We're here because we've. We can see that the state of Israel. We're here.

I didn't even mention Iran, but put security in, In. In Tron, whatever it was. Tron. And this is our program. It's free, it's consultative, it's democratic.

We welcome participation. We're here to serve you. And this is how we think. This is how we propose to do it.

Cards on the table. I mean, you know, manifestations of that, literally, the bar is. The bar is so incredibly low that you're like, well, if they had a PDF on their website for a certain area policy translated into all commonly spoken languages in Israel, even I think that would be a hard bar to pass. But that would be a. That would be a very favorable indication.

That's it. That's today's research task. And maybe good, I recorded that so I can get my public journal about my thoughts on what's. What I'm finding, you know, frustrating about the political cycle in Israel and just where we are as a country at the moment. Onto this notepad.